unit 2 CD1

Conversation — track 8, 10, 11

Bridget's presentation to a new client didn't go well. Her colleague Caleb tries to cheer her up.

Caleb: Chin up. It **could have been** a lot worse, you know.

Bridget: Worse? My laptop froze twice! I **should have brought** a backup.

Caleb: True. And maybe you **shouldn't have crammed** in all thirty slides.

Bridget: Don't remind me. I **could have skipped** the whole intro, honestly.

Caleb: Still, your answer on pricing was spot on. They looked properly impressed.

Bridget: Really? Then I **should have started** with that!

Caleb: Exactly. Lead with the numbers next time, and keep the rest short.

Bridget: Good tip. You **could have told** me that before I went in, though!

Study Notes

Don't remind me.
Đừng nhắc nữa (mình biết rồi).
Đáp lại khi người kia nhắc tới một chuyện không hay mà mình đã biết và không muốn nghĩ tới nữa.
Cách nói tương đương: I know, I know.

Your answer on pricing was spot on.
Câu trả lời của bạn về giá cả rất chuẩn.
"spot on" (kiểu Anh) là hoàn toàn chính xác. "properly" ở câu sau cũng là cách nói của người Anh, nghĩa là "thật sự".
Cách nói tương đương: Your answer on pricing was perfect.

Speak Like a Native — track 9

1. I should have brought a backup.
change: "should have" (đọc thành "shoulda")
linking: "brought_a"
strong: "backup"

"should have" nói nhanh thành "shoulda" /ˈʃʊdə/ "shu-đơ": âm /h/ và /v/ gần như mất. "brought a" nối thành "bro-đơ" (giọng Mỹ, t → d nhẹ).

2. It could have been a lot worse, you know.
weak: "could have been"
strong: "lot", "worse"

"could have been" lướt thành "cu-đơ-bin", "been" đọc nhẹ /bɪn/. Giọng Anh: /t/ của "lot" thường bị nuốt trước "worse"; "worse" không có /r/: /wɜːs/ "wơơs".

3. You could have told me that before I went in, though!
weak: "could have"
linking: "went_in"
strong: "before"

Nhấn mạnh "before" (lẽ ra phải nói trước, chứ không phải bây giờ) để trách đùa. "went in" nối thành "wen-nin": giọng Mỹ hay bỏ /t/ sau /n/.

- should have, could have, would have nói nhanh thành "shoulda", "coulda", "woulda" /ˈʃʊdə/, /ˈkʊdə/, /ˈwʊdə/.
- Đây chỉ là cách nói; khi viết vẫn dùng should have hoặc should've.
- Trong câu tiếc nuối, "should have" đọc nhẹ, nhấn vào thông tin chính: I should have brought a BACKUP.
- Nhấn một từ để đối lập (BEFORE, chứ không phải bây giờ) giúp lời trách nghe vui, không nặng nề.

Grammar Focus

should have / shouldn't have + V3: tiếc nuối, trách

Lẽ ra nên làm mà đã không làm, hoặc lẽ ra không nên làm mà đã làm. Dùng để tiếc cho mình hoặc trách nhẹ người khác.

I **should have saved** the file first.
You **shouldn't have stayed** up so late.
We **should have left** home earlier.

could have + V3: lẽ ra đã có thể

Một khả năng trong quá khứ nhưng đã không xảy ra. "You could have + V3" còn dùng để trách nhẹ: bạn đã có thể làm vậy mà lại không làm.

We **could have taken** a taxi, but we walked.
You **could have called** me! I was worried.
Slow down! You **could have hit** that cyclist.

Role Play — track 13

A: Chin up. It could have been a lot worse, you know.

B: Worse? My laptop froze twice! I should have _____.

A: True. And maybe you shouldn't have crammed in all thirty slides.

B: Don't remind me. I could have _____, honestly.

A: Still, your answer on pricing was spot on. They looked properly impressed.

B: Really? Then I should have started with that!

A: Exactly. Lead with the numbers next time, and keep the rest short.

B: Good tip. You could have _____ before I went in, though!

Substitution Drill — track 14

1. I should have brought a backup.
   a. tested everything first
   b. printed the slides
   c. arrived a bit earlier

2. I could have skipped the whole intro, honestly.
   a. cut the history part
   b. dropped half the slides
   c. kept it much shorter

3. You could have told me that before I went in, though!
   a. mentioned it
   b. warned me
   c. said something